

CHAPTER 3

THE FIVE LANGUAGES OF MONEY

The Guardian recently published the results of a fascinating survey. University students were put into pairs and recorded during four-minute speed dates. To the naked ear, every conversation sounded more or less the same. The students followed well-trod topics, from “What are you studying?” to “Where are you from?” But a deeper textual analysis revealed stark differences from conversation to conversation—and remarkable similarities, too. The pairs were scored on “language style matching,” and the ones whose matching scores were above average were almost *four times as likely* to pursue future contact than the pairs with dissimilar language styles. New proof for what we’ve known all along: if you and your chosen mate communicate well, it’s a good predictor of a successful relationship.

But there’s another predictor that is just as important, if not more so. I’m no linguist, but there’s one language in which both you and your partner must be fluent if you want your relationship to work: money.

THE FIVE MONEY LANGUAGES

There are five money languages that people speak, and four of them are problematic. Below I’ve outlined the “mother tongues” of